



BILL CONSOLIDATION

Allen and Sherry came into my office, obviously stressed. They were nervous about being there and embarrassed to tell me their story. Allen was an attorney with a local firm that specialized in real estate syndications. Just four years out of law school, Allen appeared to be the epitome of success. He was rising fast in the law firm because of his quick mind and hard work. He and Sherry had just bought a home in an exclusive section of their city and were expecting their first child. Their situation looked good, when viewed from the outside.

Inside, however, it was a different matter. When Allen graduated from law school, he owed a substantial amount in school loans. The interest rate on the loans was lower than average, but the monthly payments still would be made for ten years. Sherry had school loans also, though she didn't owe as much as Allen, and her monthly payments were more manageable. The loan payments restricted their spending but were within Allen's income capacity.

Within the last two years, Allen's salary and bonus had increased nicely, and his future prospects looked bright. They felt they could